SERVICENOW

Project Report

Automating Employee Data

Import Sets • Transform Maps • Dot Walking • Dictionary Override

| SkillWallet Platform | ServiceNow System Administrator Program Academic Year: 2025 – 2026

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Introduction

In modern enterprise environments, maintaining accurate and up-to-date employee records is critical for efficient operations. Manual data entry is error-prone, time-consuming, and difficult to scale. This project addresses these challenges by leveraging ServiceNow's powerful data integration and customization capabilities to automate the management of employee data within the platform.

By integrating external employee data through Import Sets and Transform Maps, this project eliminates the need for manual data entry and ensures that user records remain accurate and consistent. The use of dot walking enables real-time display of related information on Incident forms, while Dictionary Override provides table-level field customization without disrupting inherited behavior.

Abstract

The Automating Employee Data project enhances incident management in ServiceNow by integrating external employee data using Import Sets and Transform Maps. This approach eliminates manual data entry and ensures accurate user records across the platform.

The project is structured around three core stories:

- Import Data from Data Source — using Import Sets and Transform Maps to bring external employee records into ServiceNow.
- Dot Walking — enabling real-time visibility of related employee information (department, email, manager) directly on the Incident form without duplicating data.
- Dictionary Override — customizing the default Priority value for the Incident table independently of the parent Task table, ensuring incidents default to 3 – Moderate.

Together, these capabilities improve data accuracy, reduce administrative overhead, and provide incident handlers with immediate access to critical contextual information.

Objectives

- Eliminate manual data entry of employee records into ServiceNow.
- Enable real-time visibility of employee information on the Incident form.
- Customize field-level behavior per table using Dictionary Override.
- Improve incident handler productivity and data accuracy.
- Maintain table inheritance without impacting the parent Task table behavior.
- Provide a scalable, structured, and efficient incident resolution workflow.

Key Features

Import Sets & Transform Maps	Seamlessly import external employee data from CSV/Excel files into ServiceNow user records.
Dot Walking	Display related data (department, email, manager) directly on the Incident form by referencing related table fields.
Dictionary Override	Override the inherited default Priority value for the Incident table only, setting it to 3 – Moderate.
Auto-Population	Fields on the Incident form auto-populate when an imported user is selected as the Caller.
Role-Based Access	Standard ServiceNow role-based access controls apply throughout the workflow.

Story	Title
Platform Key	ServiceNow (Developer Instance)
Concepts	Import Sets, Transform Maps, Dot Walking, Dictionary Override
Tables Used	Incident [incident], Task [task], u_incident_table
Data Source	External Employee Data (CSV / Excel format)
Field Modified	Priority (Dictionary Override — default value customization)
Result	Priority defaults to 3 – Moderate on Incident table only
Program	ServiceNow System Administrator
Platform	SkillWallet

Story 1 — Import Data from Data Source

This story covers importing external employee data into ServiceNow using Import Sets and Transform Maps. The goal is to eliminate manual data entry and ensure user records in ServiceNow are accurate and up to date.

Step-by-Step Implementation:

1. Navigate to System Import Sets>Load Data in the Application Navigator.
2. Create a new Import Set by uploading the employee data file (CSV or Excel format).
3. Define the data source and configure the import table fields appropriately.
4. Navigate to Transform Maps and create a new Transform Map.
5. Map the source fields to the corresponding target fields in the sys_user table.
6. Run the transform to import the data into ServiceNow user records.
7. Verify that user records are created with correct department, email, and manager details.

Result of Import:

After running the transform, ServiceNow user records are automatically populated from the external data source. The mandatory fields and assigned user details are filled correctly, confirming successful data integration.

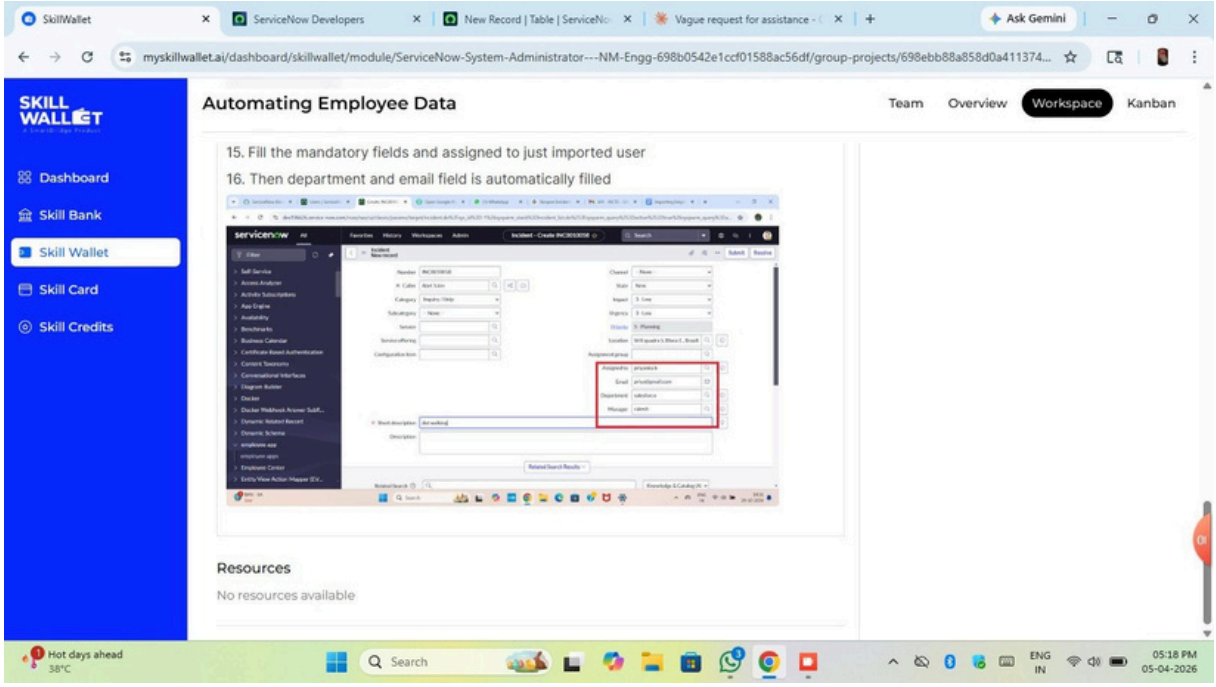

Figure 1: Incident form showing auto-populated department and email fields via dot walking after user import

Story 2 — Dot Walking

Dot walking is a ServiceNow technique that allows a field on a form to display data from a related record by traversing reference fields. Instead of duplicating data, the form references the related table directly.

Step-by-Step Implementation:

1. Open the Incidentform intheServiceNow Form Designer.
2. Add a new field using a reference field dot walk, e.g., caller_id.department to display the Caller's department.
3. Similarly add caller_id.email for the Email field and caller_id.manager for the Manager field.
4. Save the form layout and test by creating a new Incident.
5. Select a user (who was imported via Story 1) as the Caller.
6. Verify that the department, email, and manager fields auto-populate without any manual input.

Result:

When a user is selected in the Caller field on the Incident form, their related information (email, department, manager) auto-populates instantly from the referenced user record using dot walking. No data duplication occurs — the information is read directly from the user table.

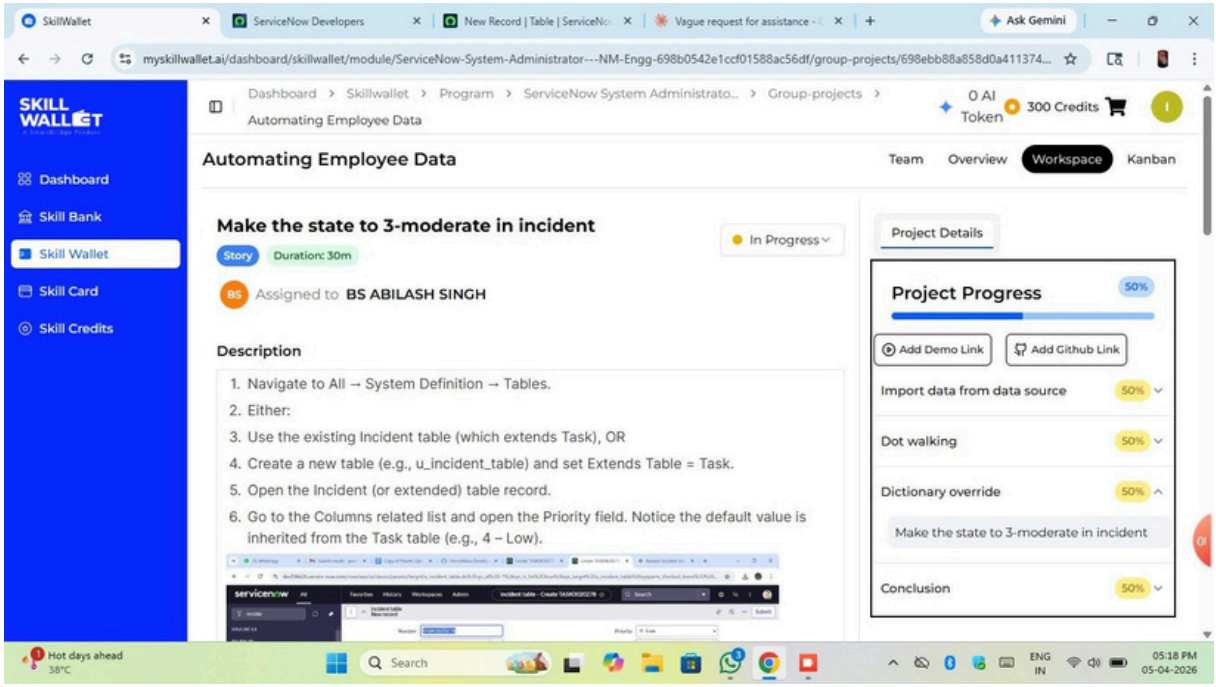

Figure 2: SkillWallet platform showing the 'Make the state to 3-moderate' story under Dictionary Override

Story 3 — Dictionary Override

Dictionary Override is a powerful ServiceNow feature that allows a child table to override specific attributes of a field inherited from a parent table. In this story, the Priority field's default value is overridden specifically for the Incident table, without affecting the Task table from which it is inherited.

Step-by-Step Implementation:

1. Navigate to All >SystemDefinition > Tables in the Application Navigator.
2. Either use the existing Incident table or create a new table (u_incident_table) that extends Task.
3. Open the Incident (or extended) table record.
4. Go to the Columns related list and locate and open the Priority field.
5. Notice the default value is inherited from the Task table (e.g., 4 – Low).
6. Scroll down and locate the Dictionary Overrides related list.
7. Click New under Dictionary Overrides.

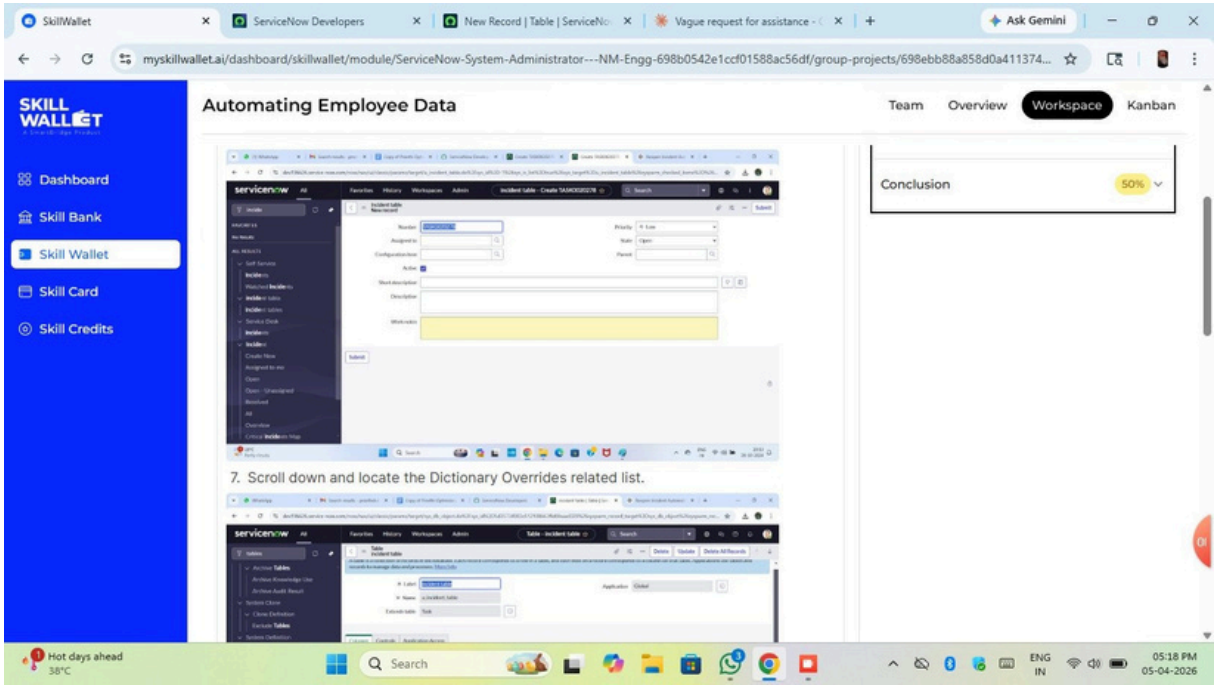

Figure 3: ServiceNow table showing the Dictionary Overrides related list on the incident_table

Story 3 — Dictionary Override (continued)

Continuing the Dictionary Override configuration:

8. Fillthe following details intheDictionary Overrideform:
9. Table: Incident (or your extended table — u_incident_table)
10. Column name: priority
11. Check the Override default value checkbox.
12. Set Default value = 3.
13. Click Submit to save the override.
14. Open a new Incident record and verify that the Priority now defaults to 3 – Moderate.
15. Open a new Task record and verify it still retains the original default value of 4 – Low.

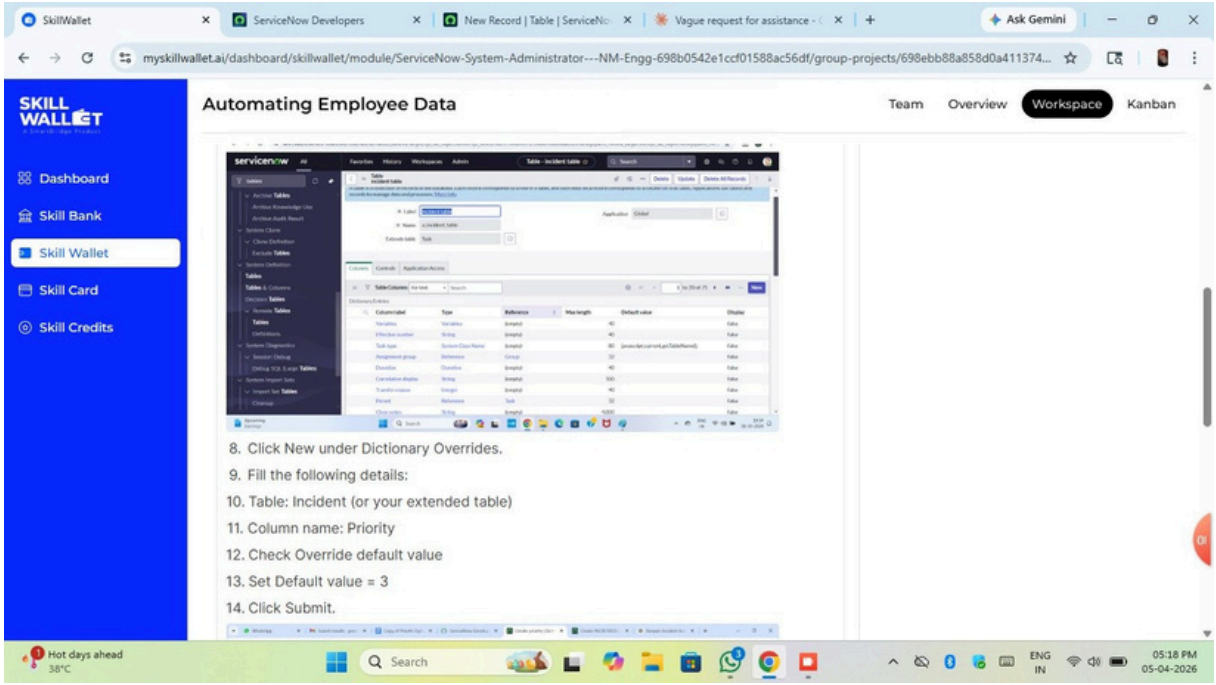

Figure 4: Table columns view showing the incident_table extending Task with all inherited fields

Verification & Testing

After completing all three stories, the following verification steps were performed to confirm that the implementation works as expected:

- Imported employee records appear correctly in ServiceNow with accurate department, email, and manager fields.
- Opening a new Incident and selecting an imported user as Caller causes department, email, and manager to auto-populate via dot walking.
- The Priority field on a new Incident record defaults to 3 – Moderate (as set by Dictionary Override).
- The Priority field on a new Task record still defaults to 4 – Low (parent table unchanged).
- The Dictionary Override entry is visible in the Dictionary Overrides related list on the Incident table.

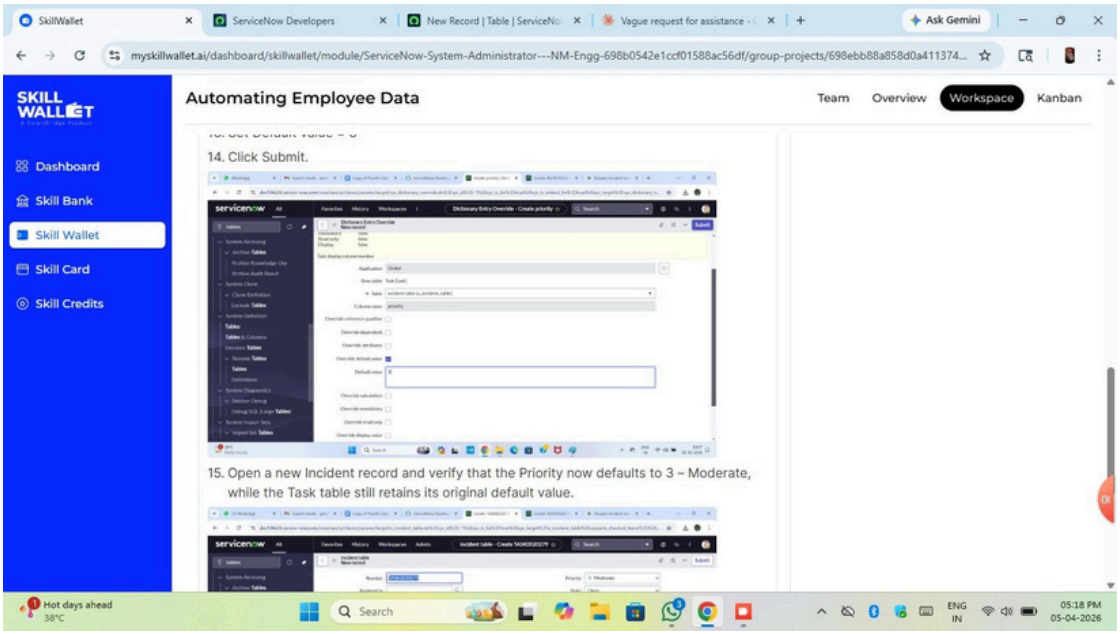

Figure 5: Dictionary Entry Override form — setting Default value = 3 for Priority on the Incident table

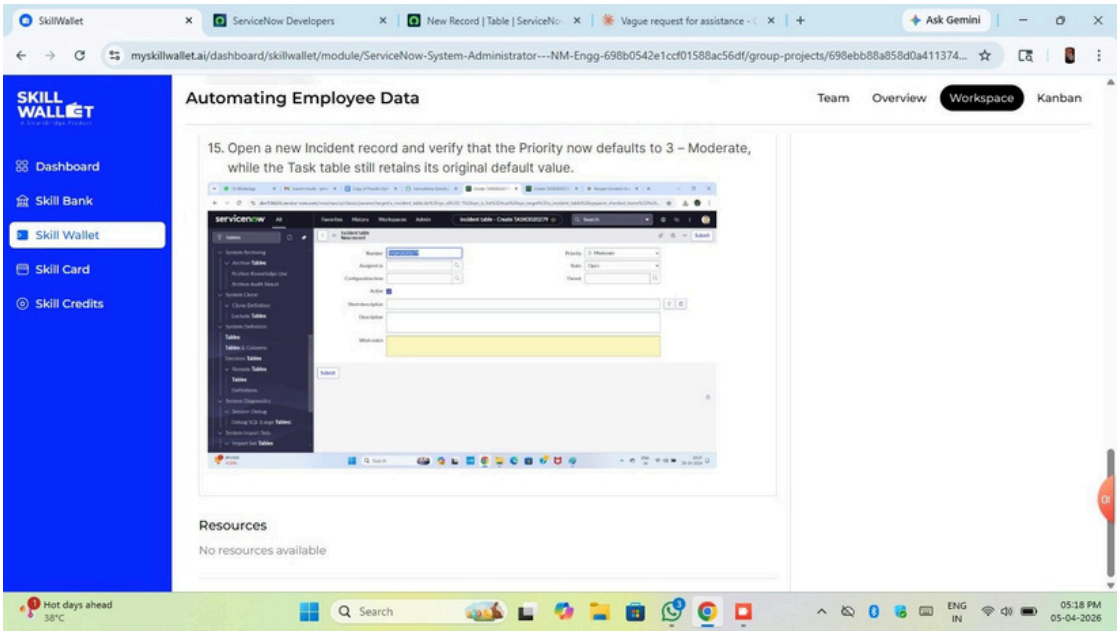

Figure 6: New Incident record showing Priority defaulting to 3 – Moderate after Dictionary Override